



EAST WEST UNIVERSITY

Physics Lab  
Department of MPS

Course Name: Engineering Physics -1

Course Code : PHY 109 LAB

Section No : 08

Group No : 05

Experiment No : 04

Name of the Experiment: To determine the wavelength of various spectral lines by a spectrometer using a plane diffraction grating.

Date of allocation : 12.11.24

Date of submission : 19.11.24

Submitted To : Md. Hedayet Ullah

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19.11.24



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Physics Lab  
PHY-109 LAB

PHY-103 LAB  
Experiment NO. 04

Name of the Experiment : To determine the wavelengths of various spectral lines by a spectrometer using a plane diffraction grating.

Theory :  $\Rightarrow$  When light passes through a narrow slit then light spreads out, this phenomenon is called diffraction.

$\Rightarrow$  When wavelength,  $\lambda$  is comparable with the slit's width,  $d$ , then diffraction becomes pronounced, ~~for~~  $d \approx \lambda$ .

$\Rightarrow$  The diffraction grating, a useful device for analyzing light sources, consists of a large number of equally spaced parallel slits.

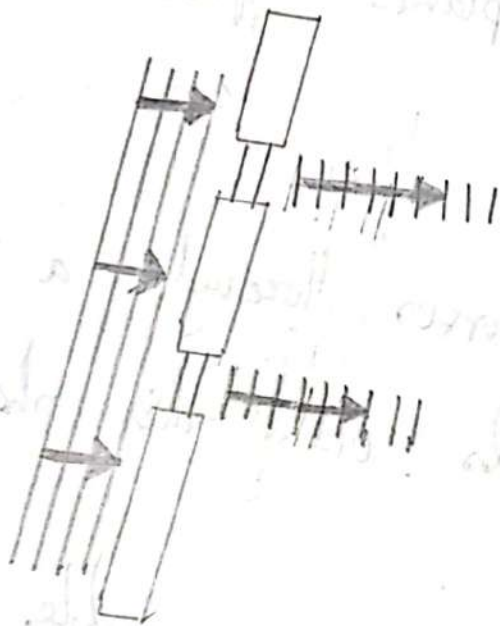


Figure : Diffraction (spreading)  
is not pronounced

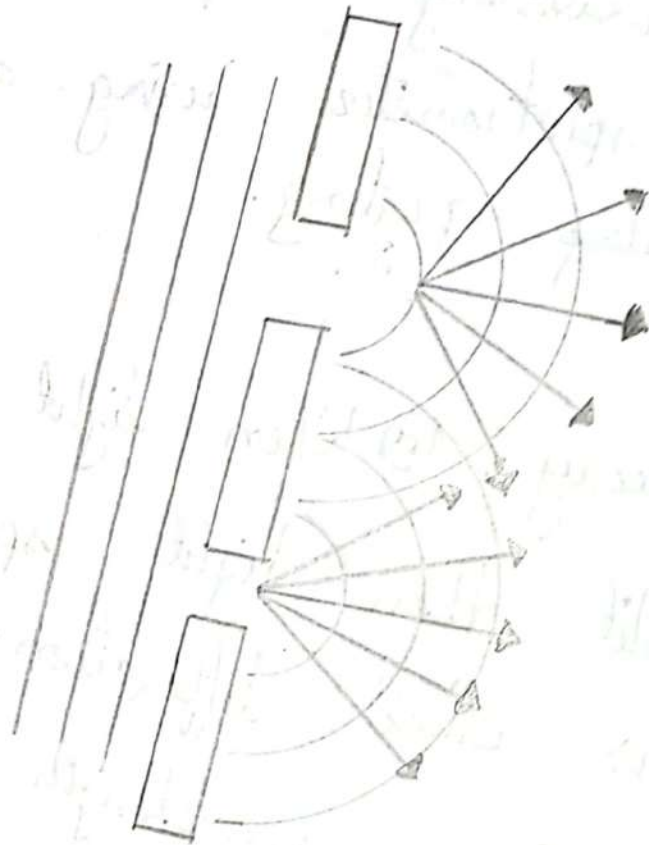


Figure : Diffraction not pronounced.

Q If a grating is ruled with 5000 lines/cm then it has a slit spacing  
 $d = \frac{1}{5000} \text{ cm} = 2 \times 10^{-4} \text{ cm}.$

If parallel rays of monochromatic light of wavelength  $\lambda$ , coming out of the collimator of a spectrometer falls normally on a plane diffraction grating placed vertically on a prism table then a series of diffracted image of the collimator slit will be seen on both sides of direct image.

Parallel rays of a monochromatic light of wavelength  $\lambda$  are incident on a diffraction grating in which the slit separation is  $(a+b)$ . If the grating has  $N$  lines per unit length, then the grating spacing is given by :

$$a+b = \frac{1}{N} \dots \dots \dots (1)$$

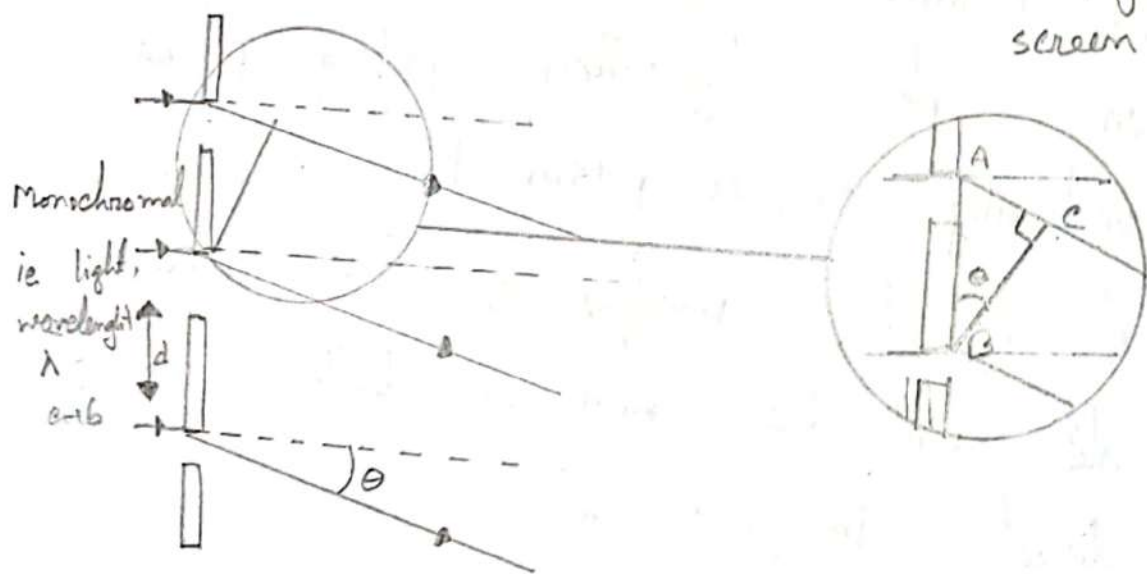
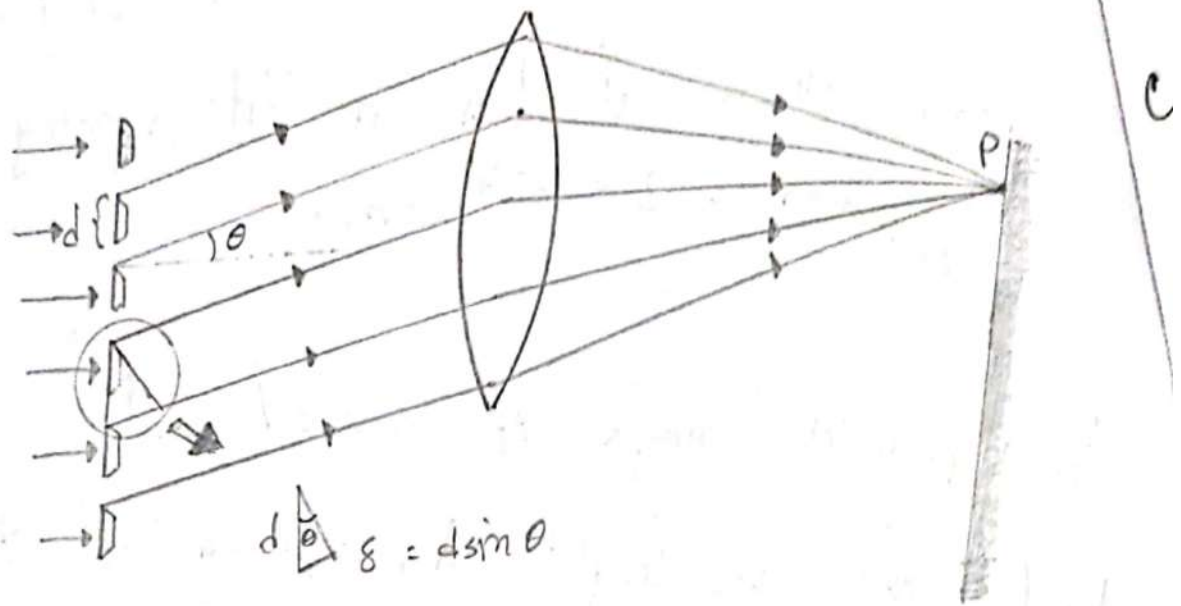


Figure: Side view of a diffraction grating.  
The slit separation is  $d$ , and the path difference between adjacent slits is  $d \sin \theta$



Constructive interference only occurs along a few precise directions, one of which is shown in the diagram. Light from A must be in phase ~~at~~ <sup>with</sup> light from B, and this can only happen when the path difference is a whole number of complete wavelengths (even number of half-wavelengths).

Path difference,  $AC = n\lambda$  where  $n = 0, 1, 2, 3, \dots$

Therefore,  $(a+b) \sin \theta = n\lambda \dots \dots \dots (2)$

where,  $\theta$  is the angle of diffraction.

The term  $n$  is called the spectrum order.

If  $n = 1$ , we have the first order diffraction maximum.  $\sin \theta$  can never be greater than 1, so there is a limit to the number of spectra that can be obtained.

Thus  $\frac{\sin \theta}{N} = n\lambda$  ..... (3)

$\therefore \lambda = \frac{\sin \theta}{nN}$  ..... (4)

The wavelength ~~at~~  $\lambda$  of any unknown light can be found out with the help of equation (4).

Apparatus :

- ⊞ Spectrometer
- ⊞ Spirit Level
- ⊞ Plane diffraction level grating.
- ⊞ Discharges tube, etc. ✓

Data Sheet: Diffraction grating experiment:

$$1 \text{ inch} = 2.54 \text{ cm.}$$

$$1 \text{ m} = 100 \text{ cm} = 10^9 \text{ nm}$$

$$\text{Vernier Constant (V.C.)} = \frac{\text{Value of the smallest division in Main scale}}{\text{Total number of divisions in Vernier scale}} = \frac{1}{60}$$

Grating constant,  $N$  = the number of lines or rulings per nanometer of the grating surface

$$= \frac{15000}{2.54}$$

| N<br>u<br>m<br>b<br>e<br>r<br>o<br>f<br>o<br>r<br>d<br>e<br>r<br>n | Desc<br>ri<br>p<br>t<br>i<br>o<br>n<br>o<br>f<br>t<br>h<br>e<br>l<br>i<br>n<br>e | Reading for the angle of Diffraction $\theta$               |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                 |                              | Wave<br>length.<br>$\lambda = \frac{\sin \theta}{n \cdot N}$<br>nm<br>or<br>m |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------|------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                                                                    |                                                                                  | Left Side                                                   |                                                                                              |                                                                     | Right Side                                                  |                                                                                              |                                                                     | $2\theta$<br>= $L$<br>~ $R$<br>in<br>degr<br>ee | $\theta$<br>in<br>deg<br>ree |                                                                               |
|                                                                    |                                                                                  | Main<br>scal<br>e<br>read<br>ing<br>(S)<br>in<br>deg<br>ree | Vern<br>ier<br>scale<br>read<br>ing<br>(V)<br>$V =$<br>$V.C. \times Div$<br>in<br>degr<br>ee | Total<br>read<br>ing<br>(L)<br>$L =$<br>$S + V$<br>in<br>degr<br>ee | Main<br>scal<br>e<br>read<br>ing<br>(S)<br>in<br>deg<br>ree | Vern<br>ier<br>scale<br>read<br>ing<br>(V)<br>$V =$<br>$V.C. \times Div$<br>in<br>degr<br>ee | Total<br>read<br>ing<br>(R)<br>$R =$<br>$S + V$<br>in<br>deg<br>ree |                                                 |                              |                                                                               |
| 1                                                                  | Violet                                                                           | 70                                                          | 0.217                                                                                        | 70.217                                                              | 100                                                         | 0.067                                                                                        | 100.067                                                             | 29.85                                           | 14.925                       | $4.36 \times 10^{-7}$                                                         |
|                                                                    | Indigo                                                                           | 71.5                                                        | 0.067                                                                                        | 71.567                                                              | 100.5                                                       | 0.123                                                                                        | 101.623                                                             | 30.114                                          | 15.057                       | $4.40 \times 10^{-7}$                                                         |
|                                                                    | Blue                                                                             | 69                                                          | 0.20                                                                                         | 69.2                                                                | 101                                                         | 0.083                                                                                        | 101.083                                                             | 31.883                                          | 15.94                        | $4.65 \times 10^{-7}$                                                         |
|                                                                    | Green                                                                            | 68                                                          | 0.25                                                                                         | 68.25                                                               | 102                                                         | 0.05                                                                                         | 102.05                                                              | 33.8                                            | 16.9                         | $4.92 \times 10^{-7}$                                                         |
|                                                                    | Yellow                                                                           | 66                                                          | 0.2                                                                                          | 66.2                                                                | 106                                                         | 0.1                                                                                          | 106.1                                                               | 39.3                                            | 18.45                        | $5.78 \times 10^{-7}$                                                         |
|                                                                    | Orange                                                                           |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                 |                              |                                                                               |
|                                                                    | Red                                                                              | 65                                                          | 0.15                                                                                         | 65.15                                                               | 110                                                         | 0.05                                                                                         | 110.05                                                              | 44.9                                            | 22.35                        | $6.60 \times 10^{-7}$                                                         |
| 2                                                                  | Violet                                                                           |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                 |                              |                                                                               |
|                                                                    | Indigo                                                                           |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                 |                              |                                                                               |
|                                                                    | Blue                                                                             |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                 |                              |                                                                               |
|                                                                    | Green                                                                            |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                 |                              |                                                                               |
|                                                                    | Yellow                                                                           |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                 |                              |                                                                               |
|                                                                    | Orange                                                                           |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                 |                              |                                                                               |
|                                                                    | Red                                                                              |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                             |                                                                                              |                                                                     |                                                 |                              |                                                                               |



Calculation: Wavelength,  $\lambda = \frac{\sin \theta}{nN} = \dots\dots\dots$

|                                                                                                            | Violet | Indigo | Blue | Green | Yellow | Orange | Red |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------|------|-------|--------|--------|-----|
| Standard value of Wavelength of different Color of Sodium Light (mainly yellow color) Source<br><i>nm</i>  | 447    | 450    | 471  | 502   | 588    | 620    | 668 |
| Standard value of Wavelength of different Color of Mercury Light (mainly Violet color) Source<br><i>nm</i> | 405    | 436    | -    | 546   | 578    | 615    | -   |
| Experimental Value of wavelength in <i>nm</i>                                                              | 436    | 440    | 465  | 492   | 578    | ....   | 660 |

$$\text{Percentage Difference} = \frac{\text{Standard value} - \text{Experiment al value}}{\text{Standard value}} \times 100\%$$

Percentage difference (Violet color) =  $\{(447 - 440) \div 447\} \times 100 = 2.46\%$   
 Percentage difference (Indigo color) =  $\{(450 - 440) \div 450\} \times 100 = 2.22\%$   
 Percentage difference (Blue color) =  $\{(471 - 465) \div 471\} \times 100 = 1.274\%$   
 Percentage difference (Green color) =  $\{(502 - 492) \div 502\} \times 100 = 1.992\%$   
 Percentage difference (Yellow color) =  $\{(588 - 578) \div 588\} \times 100 = 1.7\%$   
 Percentage difference (Orange color) = .....  
 Percentage difference (Red color) =  $\{(668 - 660) \div 668\} \times 100 = 1.2$

**Results:**

|                         | Violet | Indigo | Blue | Green | Yellow | Orange | Red |
|-------------------------|--------|--------|------|-------|--------|--------|-----|
| Wavelength in <i>nm</i> | 436    | 440    | 465  | 492   | 578    | ....   | 660 |

## Results :

|                  | Violet | Indigo | Blue | Green | Yellow | Orange | Red |
|------------------|--------|--------|------|-------|--------|--------|-----|
| Wavelength in nm | 436    | 440    | 465  | 492   | 578    |        | 660 |

## Discussion :

- ① We must position the light source directly in front of the collimator slit. This will maximize the amount of light entering the system, resulting in a bright image.
- ② We should align vertical cross-wire, or preferably the center of the cross wires, with the edge of the slit image. It is essential to eliminate parallax between the cross-wires and the image.
- ③ To avoid backlash error, we must rotate the telescope's tangent screw consistently in the same direction during final adjustments.
- ④ We should minimize the slit width for optimal image resolution. Also, when taking readings, we must carefully note any zero crossing on the main circular scale to ensure accurate measurements.